

Cloudpoint's Project Management Approach

Executive Summary	2
Key Responsibilities and Focus Areas	2
1. Project Manager	2
2. Project Lead	3
3. Key Differences	4

Executive Summary

This document outlines the role definitions, responsibilities, key functions, and areas of focus generally expected of staff designated as a **Project Manager (PM)** or **Project Lead (PL)** for the successful delivery of Cloudpoint projects. These responsibilities and functions often overlap and require regular communication between PM and PL. The PM has overall responsibility for the delivery and success of the project, and therefore has ultimate decision-making responsibility based on coordination with the Project Lead and relevant Team Lead.

Key Responsibilities and Focus Areas

1. Project Manager

A **Project Manager (PM)** is responsible for the overall planning, execution, monitoring, and closure of a project. This role is generally broader and involves managing not just the technical aspects of the project but also the business, budgeting, and communication aspects of the project.

Key Responsibilities:

- **Planning and Organizing:** Develops the project plan, sets timelines, assigns resources, and defines the project's objectives.
- **Scope Management:** Ensures the project stays within the defined scope and manages any changes in scope through formal processes.
- **Budgeting:** Manages the project budget, ensuring that costs stay within the approved limit and making adjustments as necessary.
- **Resource Allocation:** Assigns the right people and resources to the project tasks and ensures resources are effectively utilized.
- **Risk Management:** Identifies potential risks, develops mitigation strategies, and proactively manages any issues that arise.
- **Communication:** Acts as the primary point of contact between stakeholders, sponsors, and the project team. Provides regular status updates and ensures alignment on goals and progress. The PM should be included on all communication with the Client, however they do not have to be the initiator of all communication.
- **Leadership and Decision-Making:** Has the authority and responsibility to make decisions, resolve conflicts, and adjust the course of the project if needed. Any issues that arise during the course of the project should be brought to the attention of the PM immediately.
- **Quality Assurance:** Ensures that there is a plan in place for reviewing quality standards during the course of the project. Responsible for ensuring the project meets (preferably exceeds) the expectations outlined in the contract. As this responsibility falls on the PM, all deliverables must be reviewed by the PM prior to being sent to the Client. The PM

should be the default when sending deliverables, however they may delegate this as they see fit.

- **Closing:** Ensures proper project closure, including documentation, final reporting, and post-project analysis (lessons learned).

Focus Areas:

- Broad, strategic oversight.
- Budget and timeline management.
- Reporting to higher-level stakeholders (Team Lead and Client).
- Balancing multiple projects and managing interdependencies.
- Formal authority over project direction.

2. Project Lead

A **Project Lead** typically focuses more on the technical leadership of the project. They are often responsible for managing a specific part or parts of the project or leading the team through the technical aspects of execution. This role may be narrower in scope and more hands-on compared to the Project Manager.

Key Responsibilities:

- **Task and Team Management:** Leads the day-to-day operations of the project team, assigns tasks, monitors progress, and ensures technical deliverables are met.
- **Technical Oversight:** Provides expertise in the technical aspects of the project, often making decisions on design, architecture, or development approach.
- **Motivating the Team:** Ensures the project team is motivated, has clear direction, and has what they need to complete their tasks.
- **Collaboration with PM:** Works closely with the Project Manager to ensure alignment on timelines, resources, and risks, but focuses on the team's execution of tasks. All work that goes to the Client must be reviewed by the PM first.
- **Problem-Solving:** Handles challenges or bottlenecks that arise during the day-to-day work of the project team. Must inform PM of problems and risks immediately.
- **Reporting:** Provides regular updates on task completion, progress, and issues to the Project Manager or stakeholders as appropriate.
- **Mentorship:** May mentor junior team members or provide guidance to ensure best practices are followed.

Focus Areas:

- Project team management and execution of tasks.
- Technical decision-making.
- Ensuring daily operations align with project goals.
- Often more hands-on and involved in specific project work than PM.

- Focused on ensuring project deliverables meet requirements from a technical or team perspective.

3. Key Differences

1. Responsibility:

- **Project Manager:** Broad, responsible for the entire lifecycle of the project, including scope, budget, risk, and communication with stakeholders.
- **Project Lead:** Narrower, focused on leading the team and ensuring technical or operational aspects are completed.

2. Decision-Making Authority:

- **Project Manager:** Has authority over major project decisions, budget adjustments, and scope changes.
- **Project Lead:** Typically has authority over technical decisions but must defer to the Project Manager for broader issues.

3. Stakeholder Management:

- **Project Manager:** Manages communication with upper management, clients, and sponsors.
- **Project Lead:** Usually interacts more directly with the team and possibly middle management or technical stakeholders.

4. Focus on Execution:

- **Project Manager:** Focused on the big picture and the overall success of the project.
- **Project Lead:** More focused on the day-to-day tasks and team performance.

In summary, a **Project Manager** typically has a broader, strategic role involving oversight of the entire project, while the **Project Lead** focuses on operational leadership and execution within the project, often with a more hands-on approach.